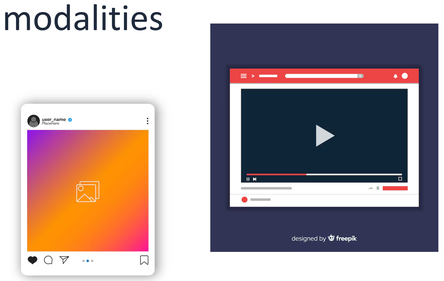
Designing for Facilitation in Ephemeral Social Spaces

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Background

Traditional interaction modalities





RQ: *How does the introduction of ephemerality, voice, and embodiment complicate platform governance?*



*Icon by IMG visuals icons from Noun Project

Study 1: Social VR

Exploring novel and amplified harms and moderation challenges



METHOD

100 events observed on 3 social VR platforms (Rec Room, AltspaceVR, Horizon Worlds)

11 moderators interviewed

FINDINGS

- Designing spaces with moderation in mind

> *"the audience actually sticks to sitting in those chairs even though we're all just standing or sitting in our own chairs [...] So it's actually **much easier to moderate the room with chairs** because everyone's more evenly spread, you know, instead of just hugging any other surface around them" (P11)*

- How spatial visibility shapes practices

> *"you can expect moderators to be roaming around and to just, you know, **generally go where there are clumps of people and listen for things.**" (P3)*

Adoption of facilitatory practices

45% of events involved harms

49% of all events where a harmful behavior occurred had no moderators present

Study 2: Social Audio

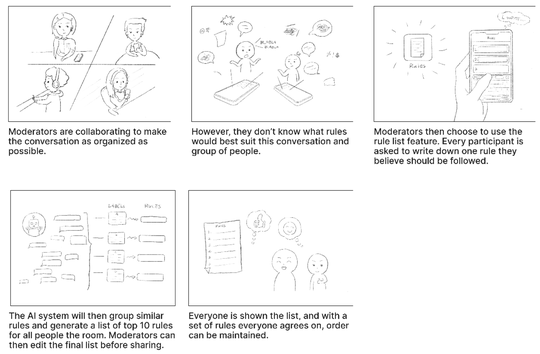
Investigating challenging facilitation tasks and possible technological solutions

METHOD

337 users surveyed

14 moderators and users in co-design interviews, using storyboards

16 training sessions analyzed



Moderators are collaborating to make the conversation as organized as possible.

However, they don't know what rules would best suit this conversation and group of people.

Moderators then choose to use the rule list feature. Every participant is asked to write down one rule they believe should be followed.

The AI system will then group similar rules and generate a list of top 10 rules for all people the room. Moderators can then edit the final list before sharing.

Everyone is shown the list, and with a set of rules everyone agrees on, order can be maintained.

Example storyboard used in interviews

FINDINGS

Issue	%
Encouraging participation or inviting responses	29.9%
Helping group members become comfortable with using the platform	28.1%
Helping the group resolve differences or conflicts	25.5%
Setting up rules/norms	24%

> *"[the host] is simply **just not putting any kind of a control.** And they're just allowing people that are willing to, spout off [...]" (P13)*

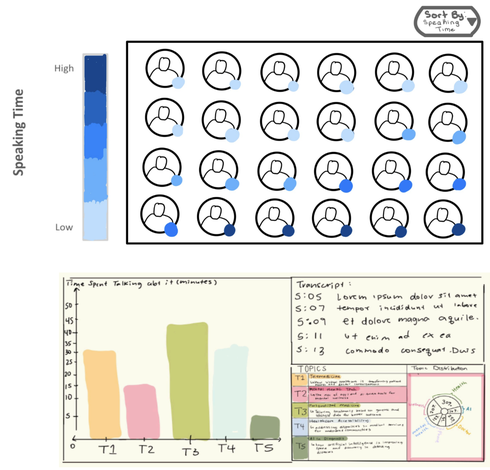
> ***"you really are the captain of your ship.** What you want in your room is what you want" (R4)*

Study 3: Highlighting Conversation Quality

Surfacing conversation quality for reflection and assistance

METHOD

26 facilitators in co-design interviews (14 educational, 12 social audio), using design probes



FINDINGS

- Interest in metrics about engagement or those that allow for planning

> ***"I get very little feedback.** I mean, they are asked to evaluate each session, and some of them do [...] But mostly I don't get feedback [...] It's hard to know how engaged people really are" (S9)*

- Guidance & alternatives to intervention valued, potentially due to high emotional burden

> *"not just for me to be able [to keep track but] for everyone else to also see [... so] people would **self-correct**" (E1)*

- Fears of creating silence or gamification